

Section I - Module A: Textual Conversations

20 marks

Attempt One question from Questions 1-7

Allow about 40 minutes for this section

Answer the question in a writing booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer you will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of how composers are influenced by another text's concepts and values
- evaluate the relationships between texts and contexts
- organise, develop and express ideas using language appropriate to audience, purpose and form

Question 1 — Shakespearean Drama and Film (20 Marks)

How is your appreciation and understanding of *King Richard III* influenced by your viewing of *Looking for Richard*?

The prescribed texts are:

- William Shakespeare, *King Richard III*
- and
- Al Pacino, *Looking for Richard*

OR

Question 2 — Prose Fiction and Film (20 Marks)

How is your appreciation and understanding of *Mrs Dalloway* influenced by your viewing of *The Hours*?

The prescribed texts are:

- Virginia Woolf, *Mrs Dalloway*
- and
- Stephen Daldry, *The Hours*

Question 3 — Prose Fiction and Prose Fiction (20 marks)

How is your appreciation and understanding of *The Stranger* influenced by your reading of *The Meursault Investigation*?

The prescribed texts are:

- Albert Camus, *The Stranger*
- and
- Kamel Daoud, *The Meursault Investigation*

OR

Absurdist

OR

Eurocentric, product of times
politically contingent

→ reimagines to reveal

MOD A

It is only through a reading of Kamel Daoud's *The Meursault Investigation* 2013 (TMI), that where he reimagines the story of Albert Camus' *The Stranger* 1943 (TS) through the perspective of the Arab dead brother, that the audience is able to gain appreciation for the universality of Camus' absurdist philosophy. However, audiences also ~~understand~~ gain insight in TS Eurocentric base ~~that~~ ~~where~~ where it is a product of its time that is complicit in colonial erasure and only explores existentialism from a perspective of power, ignoring those who are marginalised. Camus, writing in Nazi occupied France, explores the absurd as the metaphysical crises born from the crises indifference and ~~the~~ human desire. Thus, Daoud, who was raised in FLN ruled Algeria is able to spread light by revealing the colonial base of TS through recontextualisation.

Daoud's TMI reimagines the Arab perspective in TS, giving narrative voice to the marginalized group and revealing that TS is complicit in colonial erasure. Camus explores existential detachment through ~~the~~ ~~as~~ ~~it~~ ~~is~~ ~~that~~ ~~readers~~ ~~recognise~~ ~~that~~ ~~TS~~ ~~is~~ ~~not~~ ~~explores~~ ~~existentialism~~ ~~through~~ ~~a~~ ~~Pied-Noir~~ ~~perspective~~ ~~which~~ ~~creates~~ ~~an~~ ~~ideological~~ ~~structure~~ ~~that~~ ~~underpins~~ ~~its~~ ~~exploration~~. In TS, Meursault's apathy is evident in "Maman was buried now -- nothing had changed" where Meursault's truncated sentences and emotional detachment underscore his filial detachment which becomes an ~~under~~

comes for the broader French disconnection from Algeria. Additionally, Merisault dehumanises the Arab population "They were staring at us as if we were nothing but stones or dead trees". The simile reflects the corporeal silencing of native Algerians, reducing them to narrative and philosophical mechanisms rather than fully realised individuals. It is only through THE powerful message that Daoud is able to ~~reclaim~~ reclaim the Arab ~~as~~ as an individual rather than a narrative device as writing "Mother imposed on me 'a stark duty of reincarnation... she made me wear my brother's clothes'" using metaphor of 'reincarnation' to signal that ~~Daoud~~ Daoud's forced identity reveals that Daoud is forced into ~~as~~ the position of an outsider due to the intergenerational colonial trauma, rather than the choice Merisault enjoys. Daoud critiques 'colonial erasure' "They watch us... as if we were nothing but stones or dead trees" where he intertextually subverts Camus' metaphor to reclaim ~~that~~ the Arab perspective, revealing that IS colonial viewpoint renders the native population voiceless. Thus, it is through a reading of ~~IS~~ THE that ~~the~~ IS is revealed as not only an exploration of existentialism, but also a narrative that ~~creates~~ encourages alienation ~~the~~ encourages colonial marginalises the Arab.

While IS tackles the core existential concerns of living authentically under systems of oppression, it is only through a reading of THE that readers understand that Merisault's existentialism is contingent on his political reality. Daoud reimagines IS from a post-colonial

lens and critiques the rise of religious fundamentalist
parties like the MDP, revealing how ~~the~~ systems
of governance can oppress in the same way
that colonialism did. After the murder the
apathetic anti-hero is delineated in the
chapter - "it was like knocking four quick
nails on the door of unhappiness" ~~which~~ which
reflects his lack of empathy towards the Arab,
which is only possible because of the broader
French indifference to the colonized. This position
his ~~exhibitionism~~ as a Doan intertextually responds
"it was like two sharp raps on the door of
belongance" proving Haras act as a pursuit of
justice and identity to that intergenerational
colonial wounds, the allowing respondents to
~~consider~~ understand that Mersault's ~~apathy~~ was
existential detachment was a result of
his political climate that already dehumanized
the Arab, allowing for his apathy. ~~That~~ That
critiques Islamic fundamentalist governance
as preventing ~~is~~ existential liberation "There's
no one here! There's never been anyone! ~~there~~
The mosque is empty!" where the metaphor
of emptiness & illustrates the lack of authentic
lives, revealing that the power imbalance is
B is ~~the~~ what allowed for Mersault's detachment
and that unless that power imbalance is ~~prevented~~
replicated, one is unable to achieve the same
philosophy as Mersault. Thus, by reimagining
B through a post-colonial perspective, That
meaningfully ~~ref~~ deepens the audience understanding
of IS existentialism, reframing it as not
a universal human condition but a politically

contingent experience, shaped by colonial power structures.

~~It is~~ It is through TMI who comes to the same absurdist conclusion as TS that the audience is able to fully appreciate TS philosophy where death dismantles 'imposed narratives of meaning'. TMI enhances the audience's appreciation of ~~the~~ TS absurdism by creating another perspective that comes to the same conclusion, ~~without~~ thus demonstrating its accessibility. Mercant concludes his attack on the priest "It was better to burn than to disappear" ~~where~~ where the biblical imagery of 'to burn' symbolises a conscious confrontation with the absurd, where Mercant is willing to endure possible eternal damnation rather than surrender to religion and metaphorically disappear. TMI ~~relating this~~ intertextually responds "I had the right to the fire of my presence" using the same metaphor imagery of 'fire' to assert autonomy, enhancing the audience's appreciation of TS by revealing that individual existence is justified without belief in the divine. TMI concludes "There was never any survivor in that story -- everybody died all at once." aligning with TS, in depicting death as the ultimate unifying force. Through this textual conversation, when audiences read TMI they are able to fully appreciate ~~the~~ TS absurdist philosophy as ~~for both~~ both the coloniser and the colonised are able to transcend historical

boundaries and share absurdist ideologies.

Thus, audiences through reading TMT better ~~appreciate~~ understand the colonialist ~~oppress~~ oppression on IS and that existentialism is contingent on political reality. However they appreciate the universality of IS absurdism.